



Notification Waiver Determination

Vets Central – Castlemaine Veterinary Clinic, VIC

Acquisition	VC Operations (WA) Pty Ltd applied for a notification waiver in respect of its proposed acquisition of 100% of the business assets of Castlemaine Veterinary Clinic from Berkwill Pty Ltd as trustee for Berkwill Family Trust, as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	9 October 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, VC Operations (WA) Pty Ltd, together with its associated entities (collectively, Vets Central), is a veterinary group that owns and operates 88 first opinion veterinary practices across Australia and New Zealand. In Australia, Vets Central's practices provide core and ancillary veterinary services, for household pets as well as livestock, and other exotic species. The services primarily include routine, planned, and emergency veterinary services (excluding after-hours services). The target, Castlemaine Veterinary Clinic, is full-service veterinary practice in the Castlemaine area of Victoria. The business provides a range of first opinion core and ancillary veterinary services for household pets in the local area. Vets Central and Castlemaine Veterinary Clinic both supply first opinion veterinary services primarily for household pets, livestock and exotic species in Western Australia.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). Based on the information currently before it, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition given: a. there is no horizontal overlap between Vets Central and Castlemaine Veterinary Clinic in the supply of veterinary services in the Castlemaine area b. there are alternative suppliers of veterinary services in the Castlemaine area and more broadly at the regional, state and national level.

	In these circumstances, the ACCC does not consider it necessary to reach a concluded view on the likelihood of the notification thresholds being met. Given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC's guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
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**Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1)
of the Act**